

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Rashid Khan

Address: Flat 3 Glenlyon House 8A Station Road Belmont SM2 6BH

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am a local resident and I am writing in support of planning application DM2025/01591 for the former ambulance station on Dorset Road. I have looked at the application and I think this would be a positive development for the area.

The dedicated provision in this proposal is a thoughtful and practical response to that reality. The application recognises that women, families, and elderly residents have specific needs that are not currently being met locally.

This is not just a place of worship. The community hub element is open to all residents and will provide educational programmes, wellbeing sessions, social drop-ins, and interfaith activities. The benefits extend well beyond any single community.

Some objectors have suggested parking will be chaotic, but this is not supported by the evidence. There is ample room for the modest additional demand this facility would generate. The Transport Statement surveyed actual conditions and found 269 spaces with only 134 occupied at peak time.

It is also worth mentioning that the NPPF, London Plan, and Sutton Local Plan all support this type of use. I would note that refusing this application would require the Council to justify that decision against a strong policy presumption in favour of community facility provision.

The submitted noise report confirms that the building fabric will contain sound effectively. Even at the busiest time, with amplified speech during Friday prayers, the noise reaching neighbouring properties is predicted to be below ambient background levels. This meets the Local Authority's

criteria.

The travel survey data shows that 50% of Friday prayer attendees travel on foot, only 11. This is a community that predominantly walks to worship. 7% drive alone, and 20% car-share. The provision of cycle storage in the application further supports sustainable travel.

Having a local facility where residents can access wellbeing activities and social support is a genuine health benefit for the neighbourhood. The proposed community hub aligns with the growing emphasis on preventative health and social prescribing.

In addition, for residents who do not drive, or for families with young children, that distance is a real barrier. The nearest existing mosque facilities are over two miles away, in Sutton town centre and Carshalton. A facility on Dorset Road would make community and faith provision genuinely accessible for the first time.

I would also note that I note that the operating hours can be conditioned by the Council if it sees fit. The applicant has already proposed restricted hours and a daytime-weighted programme of activities. I do not see late-night disturbance as a realistic concern.

Compared to the former ambulance station, which ran 24 hours a day with emergency vehicles and sirens at all hours, the proposed use is much calmer. Operating hours are restricted, there are no large vehicles, and the activities are community-based rather than emergency-response. Neighbours will notice the difference.

The concern about school-run congestion has been raised by objectors, but the timings simply do not overlap. Friday prayers finish well before the afternoon school pickup begins. The Transport Statement addresses this evidently.

Moreover, the extension is modest, the height increase is limited, and the overall footprint of the building remains appropriate for the site. This is not a large-scale development. The design improvements will make the site look better than it has in years.

Planning decisions should be based on material planning considerations: land use, design, neighbour impact, transport, and environment. I am confident the Council will assess this application fairly on those grounds.

Moreover, on top of that, the removal of the existing keep-clear lines will actually increase the amount of on-street parking available to residents. The development will reduce the number of parking spaces on site compared to the former ambulance station, which had 21.

For all of these reasons, I strongly support planning application DM2025/01591 and I urge the London Borough of Sutton to grant planning permission.